

Powering Up Europe: EU Electrification Plan supports our thesis

New and higher electrification targets by the EU. On July 17, The European Commission published its strategy on how to accelerate the electrification of energy demand, to reach a 46% share of final energy consumption by 2040. This compares with around 23% currently. This plan is likely to bring further momentum to the roll-out of datacenters, and it may accelerate the adoption rates for heat-pumps and electric vehicles. This appears to support our bullish views on power demand growth; we recently presented a hyper-adoption scenario on electrification and datacenters, which appears aligned with the targets just expressed by the EU. On this basis, we would see power demand in Europe growing by 4–5% per annum, starting in 2029.

Electrification and AI to drive a generational earnings super-cycle. A growing electricity infrastructure deficit is likely to support higher returns across Renewables and FlexGen, while driving increased investment requirements throughout the electricity value chain – including power grids, which are currently 40 years old. Over the coming ten years, we estimate electrification will require €2.2–3.5 trn of investments, a meaningful acceleration vs the past ten years. For the main electrification compounders, this should support high-single-digit to low-double-digit average earnings growth into the 2030s, on our estimates (see [here](#)). We see this supporting an “earnings super-cycle” for the industry extending well into the 2030s. As the investment cycle unfolds, consensus earnings expectations are likely to move materially higher into 2030–31, in our view, thus supporting further multiple expansion. This may also weaken the sector’s correlation with cost of capital and commodity prices.

Who pays for electrification and AI? More affordable than perceived. We explore the cost of electrifying Europe and of rolling out datacenters to support artificial intelligence. Our analysis suggests that electricity bill increases over the coming ten years will be much lower than anticipated, averaging 2–4% pa. This should ease concerns over affordability-driven regulatory intervention and corroborates our thesis of an “earnings super cycle” in Utilities and ongoing multiple expansion. See [here](#) for details.

Favor transformative electrification stories, renewables and energy security infrastructure providers. We favor three clusters of companies: (1) *Transformative electrification stories* include companies where electrification capex is set to accelerate meaningfully (**Naturgy**, **Enel**, **Engie** and **PPC**), significantly transforming these portfolios on a 3–5 year basis; (2) *Renewable developers*, which should benefit from rising returns and organic growth opportunities (**RWE**, **EDPR**, **Solaria**, **Orsted**).

Alberto Gandolfi
+39(02)8022-0157 |
alberto.gandolfi@gs.com
Goldman Sachs Bank Europe SE – Milan
branch

Ajay Patel
+44(20)7552-1168 | ajay.patel@gs.com
Goldman Sachs International

Mafalda Pombeiro
+44(20)7552-9425 |
mafalda.pombeiro@gs.com
Goldman Sachs International

Dhwani Khenwar
+1(332)245-7724 |
dhwani.khenwar@gs.com
Goldman Sachs India SPL

Lawrence Lavizani
+44(20)7051-1060 |
lawrence.lavizani@gs.com
Goldman Sachs International

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RES manufacturers that should benefit from rising orders and margins (eg **Vestas** and **Nordex**); and (3) *Energy security infrastructure providers*, such as **EON**, **Siemens Energy**, and **Snam**.

Exhibit 1: The plan foresees a doubling in electricity consumption in final demand by 2040
Infographic

Electrification Plan	Current Status	New Target
Electrification rate (electricity share of final energy)	23%	46% by 2040 (indicative); 32% by 2030 (KPI)
Storage capacity	~55 GW (2026)	200 GW by 2030; 500 GW by 2040
Heat pump installation rate	2.4 million/yr (2025)	~4 million/yr by 2030
BEVs on EU roads	~8 million	~120 million
Heat pumps installed	~28-30 million	~100 million

Source: European Commission

Disclosure Appendix

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Contributing Authors: Alberto Gandolfi Goldman Sachs Bank Europe SE - Milan branch, Ajay Patel Goldman Sachs International, Mafalda Pombeiro Goldman Sachs International, Dhvani Khenwar Goldman Sachs India SPL, Lawrence Lavizani Goldman Sachs International.

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